Here's a comprehensive table of the **most commonly used day-to-day and one-time Linux commands** with explanations, tailored for **Cloud, DevOps, and Linux job roles and responsibilities**:

Linux Commands: Day-to-Day vs One-Time Activities

Command	Usage	Day-to-Day / One-Time	Purpose	Common in Roles
ls -l	List files with details	Day-to-Day	View file permissions, owners, and timestamps	All (Linux/Admin/DevOps)
cd /path/	Change directory	Day-to-Day	Navigate to different file paths	All
pwd	Print current directory	Day-to-Day	Confirm current working directory	All
cat file.txt	View file contents	Day-to-Day	Quickly read configuration/log files	All
less /var/log/syslog	Scroll through large files	Day-to-Day	View logs/configs with navigation	All
tail -f /var/log/messages	Real-time log monitoring	Day-to-Day	Debugging/log analysis	Cloud/DevOps/Linux
top / htop	Monitor processes	Day-to-Day	Check memory/CPU usage live	DevOps/Linux
ps aux	View running processes	Day-to-Day	Troubleshooting	All
df -h	Disk usage	Day-to-Day	Monitor disk space	All
du -sh *	Directory size summary	Day-to-Day	Analyze space usage	Linux/DevOps

free -m	RAM usage	Day-to-Day	Monitor memory utilization	All
uptime	System load & uptime	Day-to-Day	Check server health	Linux
netstat -tulnp	View open ports	Day-to-Day	Network troubleshooting	DevOps/Linux
ss -tulwn	Socket stats (modern netstat)	Day-to-Day	Check listening ports	Linux/DevOps
ping <host>	Test network connectivity	Day-to-Day	Network troubleshooting	All
curl <url> / wget <url>	Test API/Download file	Day-to-Day	API or HTTP test	DevOps
scp file user@host:/path/	Secure file copy	Day-to-Day	Transfer config/scripts	All
rsync -avz src/ dest/	Sync files/directories	Day-to-Day	Backup or deployments	DevOps
chmod +x script.sh	Make script executable	One-Time	Enable script execution	DevOps/Linux
chown user:group file	Change file ownership	One-Time	Set correct permissions	DevOps/Linux
crontab -e	Schedule jobs	One-Time	Automate scripts/tasks	DevOps/Linux
journalctl -xe	View systemd logs	Day-to-Day	Debug system services	Linux
systemctl status nginx	Check service status	Day-to-Day	Check web or DB service status	DevOps/Linux
systemctl restart nginx	Restart service	Day-to-Day	Service management	DevOps/Linux
service sshd restart	Restart legacy service	Day-to-Day	For older systems	Linux

adduser devops	Add user	One-Time	User management	Admin/Linux
usermod -aG sudo devops	Grant sudo	One-Time	Elevate user privileges	Admin/Linux
passwd devops	Set user password	One-Time	Set/change user password	Admin
iptables -L	List firewall rules	Day-to-Day	Security checks	DevOps/Security
iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT	Allow SSH	One-Time	Open port	DevOps
ssh user@host	Remote login	Day-to-Day	Access remote servers	All
history	Command history	Day-to-Day	Audit/check past actions	All
alias ll='ls -la'	Set command shortcut	One-Time	Personal efficiency	All
sudo su -	Become root	Day-to-Day	Run as root/admin	Admin/Linux
find / -name "file.txt"	Find files	Day-to-Day	Troubleshooting /config checks	All
grep "error" logfile.log	Search inside files	Day-to-Day	Log and config search	All
tar -czvf backup.tar.gz /dir	Archive files	One-Time	Backup or transfer	DevOps
unzip file.zip / tar -xvf file.tar	Extract files	Day-to-Day	Restore or extract packages	DevOps
reboot	Restart server	One-Time	System restart (planned)	Admin

 Key Notes

- **Day-to-Day Commands** are used repeatedly for monitoring, deployment, log analysis, troubleshooting.
- **One-Time Commands** are often run during server setup, configuration, or user/admin management.
- **Cloud/DevOps Context**: Many of these commands are used on AWS EC2, Azure VMs, GCP instances, and in CI/CD scripts or IaC tools (e.g., provisioning, deployment, monitoring).
- Use sudo wherever admin privileges are required.